

343 Test a bird's brain

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MINS

How smart are birds? Test them with this simple puzzle. Offer tasty treats in two pots—one closed, one open—and find out whether the birds in your yard are smart enough to figure out how to open a lid.

What you need

- 2 identical plastic pots
- Cardboard or stiff paper
- Pencil
- Scissors
- Tape
- Pebbles
- Birdseed



1 Half-fill one pot with pebbles to weigh it down, then top it off with birdseed. You'll do the same with the second pot later.



2 Trace around the second pot onto the cardboard. Cut out the shape, leaving a tab.

Birds eat from open pot first



3 Fill the second pot like the first. Tape the lid on one side. Put both pots close together. When the open pot is empty, which birds lift the lid to get the seed?



344 Identify birdsong

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Birdsong tells you which birds are nearby. When you spot a bird singing, make a note of the sounds you hear, and you'll soon learn which birds makes which songs.



Chshree-ip
Schree-eeew
Shrr-ooo

Use lines to note whether the songs go up or down